

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board: 2
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

Board: 3
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥9

Board: 4
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣5

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6 5

♠ A Q 10 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 10

♣ A 9 7 4



♠ 8 6
♥ K 7 3 2
♦ A 8 7 6
♣ 10 8 3

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♥ 3			

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 4
 ♥ J 10 7 5
 ♦ 6
 ♣ A K J 3

♠ A 7 5

♥ 3 2

♦ Q J 9 7

♣ Q 10 7 6



♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ A

♦ K 10 8 4 3

♣ 8 4 2

WEST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦.
But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

EAST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

WEST passes happily.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Dbl

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

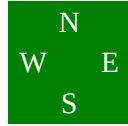
Lead: ♠10

Board 3

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5 2
♥ A 9 8
♦ K 5 2
♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A 10 9 4
♥ K Q J 7
♦ Q 6
♣ A Q 4



♠ Q 8 3
♥ 6 4 3
♦ 10 8 7 3
♣ 6 5 3

♠ J 7 6
♥ 10 5 2
♦ A J 9 4
♣ K 10 2

NORTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has good strength in WEST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

NORTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥9			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ A J 9 2
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ 10 7 5
♥ K 10 7 6
♦ 10 9 2
♣ A 5 4

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♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ Q 5
♦ K 7 4
♣ J 10 7

♠ J 3 2
♥ 8 4 3
♦ Q 8 5 3
♣ K 6 2

EAST has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1♠.

WEST also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting EAST to bid game.

Since EAST has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	1♠	
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♣5			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 10 7 6

♣ 10 7 5

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4



♠ K Q 6 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ 9 4 2

♣ 9 3 2

♠ A 9 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6

NORTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, SOUTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to NORTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

NORTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for SOUTH - he bids 4♥.

West

1♠

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

North

Dbl

3♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♠

4♥